

Safety Footwear SOP

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines the requirements for selection, use, care, and replacement of safety footwear across the facility to protect employees from foot injuries caused by falling objects, rolling loads, punctures from sharp debris, electrical hazards, slips on wet or oily floors, and exposure to chemicals. Foot injuries are among the most common recordable incidents in manufacturing and warehousing environments, and compliant footwear is a first-line control against these hazards.

2. Scope

Applies to all personnel working in production areas, warehouses, loading bays, workshops, and any zone marked with mandatory safety-footwear signage. Visitors granted floor access for more than 15 minutes must also be issued compliant footwear or approved overshoes.

3. Footwear Specification

- Steel toe-cap or composite toe-cap rated to withstand a minimum impact of 200 joules, certified to IS 15298 / ASTM F2413 / EN ISO 20345.
- Puncture-resistant midsole for areas with loose nails, metal shavings, or sharp debris.
- Slip-resistant outsole tested to a minimum coefficient of friction suitable for the specific floor surface (dry, wet, or oily).
- Electrical hazard (EH) rated soles in areas near exposed live conductors.
- Chemical-resistant uppers and soles for personnel working in the chemical handling and battery charging areas.

4. Responsibilities

Supervisors must verify footwear compliance at the start of each shift as part of the pre-work PPE check. The Stores department issues footwear based on job-role risk assessment and maintains size records for all employees. Employees must wear the issued footwear laced and fastened correctly at all times on the shop floor and must not substitute personal footwear that does not meet the certified specification.

5. Inspection Procedure

- Check the toe cap for dents or cracks that may compromise impact protection.
- Inspect the sole for excessive wear, especially loss of tread pattern which reduces slip resistance.
- Check stitching and upper material for tears, especially around the toe box and ankle.
- Verify that laces or fastenings are intact and can be securely tightened.
- Any footwear showing exposed steel/composite toe caps, sole separation, or water ingress must be replaced immediately.

6. Maintenance and Storage

Employees should clean footwear at the end of each shift to remove oil, chemical residue, or debris that can degrade materials over time. Footwear should be air-dried away from direct heat sources, as excessive heat can cause sole delamination. Personal lockers are provided for storage; footwear should not be left on the shop floor overnight.

7. Replacement Cycle

Standard-duty footwear is replaced every 6 months or immediately upon visible damage, whichever comes first. Footwear used in chemical or wet-processing areas is inspected monthly and replaced every 3 months due to accelerated material degradation. All replacements are recorded in the PPE Issue Register with employee acknowledgment.

8. Non-Compliance and Training

Entry to the production floor without compliant footwear is prohibited and will be treated as a safety violation under the plant's EHS policy. All employees receive footwear-specific training during induction, covering correct fitting, hazard identification per work area, and reporting procedures for damaged or ill-fitting footwear. Annual refresher sessions reinforce these requirements and incorporate lessons learned from any foot-injury incidents recorded during the year.